BUSINESS MANAGER

User Manual

Invoices, quotations, job notes, payments, purchases, stock and reports for your business

For business owners, managers, staff and platform administrators

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1. Introduction

Billora is an online system for running the paperwork of a small business: quotations, invoices, payments, repair job notes, purchases, supplier bills, stock and reports. It works in any modern web browser on a computer, tablet or phone, and there is nothing to install.

Each business that uses Billora gets **its own private space**, with its own address (for example **acme.billora.novixtech.lk**), its own users and its own data. No other business can see your records.

1.1 Who this manual is for

You are…	Read these chapters
Staff creating invoices, quotations, job notes and payments	2, 3 and 6 to 14
A **manager** (staff work plus reports and deleting records)	The staff chapters, plus 15
The **owner** of a business	Everything from 2 to 17
Platform staff who run Billora for many businesses	18, 19 and the appendix

1.2 What you can do

Area	What it does
Quotations	Prepare price offers, send them as PDFs and turn them into invoices in one click.
Invoices	Bill customers, with optional tax, bank details and notes. Print, download or email the PDF.
Payments	Record money received from customers and paid to suppliers. Balances update automatically.
Outstanding AR	See who owes you money and for how long.
Job notes	Take in devices for repair with the customer's on-screen signature.
Purchases and vendor bills	Record what you buy from suppliers and what you owe them.
Customers, suppliers and products	Keep contact details, prices and stock levels in one place.
Reports	Sales, purchases, profit, payments, aging, stock value and customer statements.
Settings, users, backups	Your business details and logo, staff logins with roles, and database backups.

1.3 Conventions in this manual

- Words in **bold** are the names of buttons, menu items, fields and pages exactly as they appear on screen.
- **Menu → Item** means: click Menu, then click Item.
- Fields marked with an asterisk (*) on screen must be filled in.
- Screens look slightly different on a phone: the menu is hidden behind the menu button (three lines) at the top left.

> **Tip:** Billora has a light and a dark theme. Use the half-circle button at the top right to choose **Light**, **Dark** or **Match device**.

2. Getting started

2.1 Signing up a new business

If your business is not on Billora yet, the owner signs it up once:

1. Go to the Billora website (for example **https://billora.novixtech.lk**) and click **Start your free trial**.
2. Enter your **Business name**.
3. Choose **Your address**: a short name of lowercase letters, numbers and hyphens, such as **acme**. This becomes your business's address, for example **acme.billora.novixtech.lk**. Some names (such as admin or www) are reserved, and each name can only be used once.
4. Enter **Your name**, **Email**, a **Username for signing in** and a **Password** (at least 8 characters), twice.
5. Tick **I agree to the Terms of Service and Privacy Policy** and click **Create my business**.
6. After a few seconds you are taken to your business's sign-in page. A welcome email with your address and username is sent to you as well.

> **Note:** New businesses start with a **14-day free trial**. Chapter 17 explains plans and payment.

2.2 Signing in

1. Open your business's address in the browser, for example **https://acme.billora.novixtech.lk**. Bookmark it.
2. Enter your **Username** and **Password** and click **Sign In to Dashboard**.
3. If your business has **sign-in codes** switched on, a 6-digit code is emailed to you. Type it in and click **Verify & Continue**. The code works for a few minutes; click **Didn't get a code? Resend** if it does not arrive.

> **Tip:** Forgot your business's address? Go to the Billora website, click **Sign in** or **Find my business**, and enter the email you signed up with. The address is emailed to you.

Message	What it means
Invalid username or password!	Check both and try again. Passwords are case-sensitive.
This account has been switched off	The owner has deactivated your login. Ask the owner.
Your account has no email address for sign-in codes	Sign-in codes are on, but your user has no email. The owner adds one on the Users page.
This account is paused	The business's account is paused (for example an unpaid plan). The owner contacts support.

2.3 Your own account

Click your name at the bottom of the menu to open **My account**. There you can change your **Full name**, **Email** and **password**. To change the password you must type your **Current password** first.

To sign out, click the **log out** arrow next to your name.

2.4 The owner's first day

A new business is empty. This order gets you working quickly:

1. **Settings**: business name, address, phone, email, logo and bank details (chapter 4).
2. **Users**: a login for each person, with the right role (chapter 5).
3. **Products & Stock**: the items and services you sell, with prices (chapter 7). Optional, but it makes invoices faster.
4. Create your first **quotation** or **invoice** (chapters 8 and 9).

3. The screen and the dashboard

3.1 The menu

The menu on the left is grouped by area. People only see the items their role allows.

Section	Menu items
Overview	Dashboard
Sales	Invoices, Quotations, Outstanding AR, Payments
Service	Job Notes
Purchasing	Purchases, Vendor Bills
Directory	Customers, Suppliers, Products & Stock
Insights	Reports (owners and managers)
Administration	Settings, Users, Backups, Activity Log, Plan & billing (owners)

3.2 The dashboard

The **Dashboard** is the first page after signing in. It shows the state of the business at a glance:

- **Sales and payments** for the period, and a **Sales vs collected** chart for the last 6 months.
- **Customers owe you** and **You owe suppliers**: the total outstanding on both sides.
- **Needs your attention**: for example overdue invoices and **Low stock** products.
- **Top customers**, **Recent invoices** and **Recent job notes** (with links to **View all**).
- **Jobs awaiting signature**, with a **Sign now** button for each.
- **Quick actions** for the most common tasks, such as a new invoice or job note.

> **Note:** Banners at the top of the page tell owners about things to do, such as finishing the Settings page or a trial that is about to end.

3.3 The New button

The **New** button at the top of every page is the quickest way to start something: **New Invoice**, **New Quotation**, **New Job Note**, **New Purchase**, **Receive Payment**, **Make Payment**, **Add Customer** and **Add Product**.

3.4 Lists, searching and viewing

Lists such as Invoices, Quotations and Job Notes work the same way:

- Type in the **search box** above the list to filter it instantly by any text in the row (number, customer, item…).
- Use the page buttons below the list to move through long lists.

- Click the **eye** button to open a document in a quick preview, or the document number to open its full page.
- The **pencil** button edits; the **bin** button deletes (managers and owners only), after you confirm.

4. Settings (owners)

Administration → Settings holds the details that appear on your invoices, quotations, job notes, emails and reports. Only owners can open it. Make your changes in any section and click **Save settings**. Every change is recorded in the Activity Log.

Section	What to fill in
Business	Business name (required), tagline, address (one line per row), phone, email, website, and a separate phone and email for repair jobs if you use them.
Logo	Upload a PNG or JPG logo (up to 2 MB; square or wide with a transparent background looks best). Tick **Remove my logo and use the default** to remove it.
Bank account	Account name, bank, account number and branch. Offered on invoices as payment details.
Documents	The first number for invoices, quotations and job notes, the default terms and conditions for each, and the default note shown on invoices.
Tax	Switch on **Charge tax on invoices and quotations**, then set the tax name (for example VAT), rate and your tax registration number. Each document can still be saved without tax.
Money & backups	Currency symbol (for example Rs.), after how many days an unpaid invoice counts as overdue, and how many backups to keep.
Sign-in	Switch on **Ask for an emailed code after the password**, and set the mailbox that receives codes for users who have no email of their own.

> **Tip:** Numbering only sets the **first** number. After that, each new document takes the next number after the highest one already used.

> **Important:** Before switching on sign-in codes, make sure every user has an email address (Users page) or that the fallback mailbox is filled in. Otherwise those users cannot sign in.

5. Users and roles (owners)

Give every person their own login, so the Activity Log shows who did what. Open **Administration → Users**.

5.1 Roles

Role	Can do
Owner	Everything, including Settings, Users, Backups, the Activity Log and Plan & billing.
Manager	Day-to-day work plus Reports and deleting records (and merging customers or suppliers).
Staff	Create and edit invoices, quotations, job notes, payments, purchases, customers and stock. Cannot delete, and cannot see Reports.

5.2 Adding a user

1. Click **Add user**.
2. Enter a **Username** (letters, numbers, dashes and underscores), their **Full name** and **Email**.
3. Choose the **Role**.
4. Enter a **Password** (at least 8 characters) twice, and share it with them privately.
5. Click **Add user**.

5.3 Changing or switching off a user

- Click **Edit** next to a user to change their details or role.
- To reset a password, type a **New password** twice. Leave it empty to keep the current one.
- Untick **Account is active** to switch a login off. Users are never deleted, so their history keeps its name. A switched-off user is signed out at once.
- There must always be at least one active owner, and you cannot switch off your own account.

> **Note:** Your plan may limit the number of active users. When the limit is reached, adding or switching on another user shows "Your plan allows … active users".

6. Customers and suppliers

Directory → Customers and **Directory → Suppliers** keep contact details in one place. Customers are also created automatically when you type a new name on an invoice, quotation or job note.

6.1 Adding or editing

Field	Notes
Customer / Company or Supplier	Required, and must be unique. Renaming also updates the name on the existing documents.
Contact Person, Phone, Email	The email is suggested when you email invoices, quotations and job notes.
Address, Notes	Free text.

6.2 A customer's page

Click a customer to see their documents, how much they have been billed and paid, and their balance. Sort the list by **balance** to see who owes the most.

6.3 Merging duplicates (managers and owners)

If the same customer was entered twice (for example "Acme" and "ACME Ltd"), open the one to remove, click **Merge**, choose the customer to keep under **Merge into**, and confirm. All documents move to the kept customer, missing contact details are copied over, and the duplicate is deleted.

6.4 Deleting

A customer or supplier can only be deleted when no documents use it. Otherwise merge it into another.

7. Products and stock

Directory → Products & Stock lists the items and services you sell, so you can pick them on invoices, quotations and purchases instead of typing them.

7.1 Adding a product

Field	Notes
Name	Required.
SKU / Code, Brand, Category	Optional, to find and group products.
Description	Optional. Filled into document lines when you pick the product.
Selling price	Required. Filled into the unit price on invoices and quotations.
Cost price	Used for profit and stock-value reports.
Track stock	Switch on for physical items. Leave off for services.
Reorder level	The product shows as **low stock** at or below this quantity.
Opening stock	How many you have right now (only when adding).
Active	Switch off to hide a product you no longer sell.

7.2 How stock changes

- Saving an **invoice** takes its quantities out of stock; a **confirmed or paid purchase** puts them in.
- Editing or deleting the document corrects the stock automatically. Draft and cancelled purchases do not move stock.
- Every change is listed on the product's page with the date, source and person.

7.3 Adjusting stock by hand

For counts, damaged units or returns, open the product and click **Adjust stock**. Choose **Add**, **Remove** or **Set count**, enter the **Quantity** and a **Reason** (for example "Monthly count"), and click **Save**.

8. Quotations

A quotation is a price offer. Click **New → New Quotation**, or open **Sales → Quotations** and create one there.

8.1 Creating a quotation

1. Enter **Prepared For** (the customer), the **Date**, **Valid Until** and **Prepared By**. The **Quotation #** is filled in for you.
2. Add the lines: item number, description, brand, quantity and unit price. Start typing to pick a product, or type freely. Add as many lines as you need.
3. If tax is switched on in Settings, choose whether to add tax to this quotation.
4. Check the **Terms & Conditions** (the defaults from Settings are filled in).
5. Save. Totals are always worked out by the system from quantity × price.

8.2 Sending and converting

- Open the quotation to **Download PDF**, **Email** it (chapter 14) or **Print** it.
- When the customer accepts, click **Convert to Invoice** and confirm. A new invoice is created with the same customer, lines and tax, and stock is updated.
- A quotation can only be converted once. Afterwards the button changes to **Converted to Invoice #…**, which opens that invoice. If the invoice is deleted later, the quotation can be converted again.

> **Note:** Converting counts as a new invoice for your plan's monthly invoice limit, if your plan has one.

9. Invoices

9.1 Creating an invoice

1. Click **New → New Invoice** (or open **Sales → Invoices** and create one there).
2. Enter the **Customer Name** (start typing to pick an existing customer), the **Invoice Date** and check the **Invoice Number** (the next number is filled in).
3. Add the lines: description, brand, quantity and unit price. Pick a product to fill in its price, or type freely.
4. If tax is switched on in Settings, choose whether to add tax.
5. Under **Additional Information → Display on Invoice**, choose to show your **bank details**, a **payment note**, or nothing.
6. Check the **Terms & Conditions** and save.

> **Important:** Two invoices can never have the same number. If someone else saved the same number a moment before you, you will see "Invoice number already exists"; change the number and save again.

9.2 Invoice status

Status	Meaning
Confirmed	Every new invoice. It counts in sales and stock, and can take payments.
Paid	Payments cover the full total. Set automatically, and changes back to Confirmed if a payment is removed.

9.3 Working with an invoice

- Open it to **Download PDF**, **Email** or **Print**. The PDF carries your logo, business details and the invoice's own terms.
- To record money received against it, see chapter 10.
- **Edit** changes the customer, date, lines, terms or extra information. The new total cannot be less than what has already been paid.
- **Delete** (managers and owners) is only possible when the invoice has **no payments**. Delete the payments first; this keeps your income figures correct.

> **Note:** Your plan may limit how many invoices you can create in a month (counted by invoice date). At the limit you will see "Your plan allows … invoices a month".

10. Payments

Sales → Payments lists money **Received** from customers and money **Made** to suppliers. Switch between the two at the top of the page.

10.1 Recording a payment from a customer

1. Click **New → Receive Payment** (or the payment button next to an invoice on a customer's page or in Outstanding AR, which fills the invoice in for you).
2. Under **Link to Invoice (Optional)**, choose the invoice being paid. Only confirmed invoices with a balance are listed.
3. Check the **Customer Name**, enter the **Amount** and **Payment Date**.
4. Choose the **Method** (Cash, Bank Transfer, Cheque or Online) and add a **Reference #** (transaction or cheque number) and **Notes** if useful.
5. Click **Save Payment**.

- The invoice's paid amount and balance update at once. When it is paid in full, its status becomes **Paid**.
- A payment cannot be more than the balance due. Pay part now and part later as separate payments.
- A payment without an invoice is recorded as money received from that customer.

10.2 Recording a payment to a supplier

Click **New → Make Payment** and fill in the same way. Link it to a **purchase** to reduce that purchase's balance.

10.3 Changing or deleting a payment

- Edit a payment to correct the amount, date, method or reference. The linked document's balance is recalculated.
- Managers and owners can delete a payment. The amount is taken off the linked invoice or purchase again, which goes back to **Confirmed** if it was paid.

11. Outstanding AR (who owes you)

Sales → Outstanding AR lists every customer with unpaid invoices: the number of invoices, the oldest outstanding date, what was invoiced and paid, and the **Total Amount Due**. Amounts are also grouped by age, from **Current** to older than 90 days, coloured from green to red.

- Use **Search Customer** and **Filter** to find one customer; **Clear** shows everyone again.
- Click a customer to see their outstanding invoices with what was **Paid So Far**, and search them by invoice number or item.
- From there, record a payment, or send the customer a statement (chapter 15).

> **Tip:** The number of days after which an invoice counts as overdue is set in **Settings → Money & backups**.

12. Job notes (repairs)

A job note records a device taken in for repair, with the customer's signature, and gives the customer a numbered receipt. Open **Service → Job Notes**.

12.1 Taking in a device

1. Click **New → New Job Note**. The **Job No.** is given automatically when you save.
2. **Customer Details**: **Customer / Company Name**, **Contact Person**, **Contact No.** and **Email**. Picking an existing customer fills in their saved contact details.
3. **Device Details**: the **Item** (for example "MacBook Pro 16-inch"), **Serial No.**, the **Reported Fault**, **Accessories Received** and the **Device Condition at Collection** (scratches, cracks…).
4. **Collection Details**: **Collected Date** and **Collected By**, plus any **Remarks**.
5. Check the **Terms & Conditions** (one term per line).
6. Ask the customer to sign in the **Customer Signature** box with a finger or mouse. This is optional now; it can be signed later.
7. Save, then **Print** or **Email** the job note for the customer.

12.2 Signing later and changing a signature

- Unsigned job notes appear under **Jobs awaiting signature** on the dashboard. Click **Sign now**, let the customer sign, and click **Save Signature**.
- A signed job note keeps its signature when edited. To replace it, edit the job note, choose **Remove this signature**, and sign again.

13. Purchases and vendor bills

13.1 Purchases

Purchasing → Purchases records what you buy from suppliers, line by line, like an invoice in reverse.

1. Click **New → New Purchase**. Enter the **Supplier Name**, a **PO Number** if you use them, the **Date** and the **Status**.
2. Add the lines: pick a product (optional), description, brand, **Qty** and **Unit Price**. Use **Add Item** for more lines.
3. Add **Notes** if needed and save.

Status	Meaning
Draft	Not final yet. Does not change stock.
Confirmed	Bought. Puts the quantities into stock and can take payments.
Paid	Fully paid. Set automatically by payments.
Cancelled	Not going ahead. Does not change stock.

13.2 Vendor bills

Purchasing → Vendor Bills is for bills that are not item-by-item purchases, such as rent, utilities or services.

- Enter the **Supplier Name**, **Bill Number**, **Bill Date**, **Due Date**, **Total Amount** and any **Amount Already Paid**.
- The status is set for you: **Unpaid**, **Partially paid**, **Paid**, or **Overdue** once the due date has passed.
- Edit the bill and update **Amount Paid** as you pay it. The list shows totals for **Pending Bills** and what is overdue.

14. Emailing documents

Invoices, quotations, job notes and customer statements can be emailed as PDF attachments. Open the document and click **Email**.

1. **To** is filled in from the customer's saved email if there is one. Otherwise type it, and tick the box to **save this address** on the customer for next time.
2. Add **CC** addresses if needed (separate several with commas).
3. Check the **Subject** and **Message**. They are written for you with the document's number and amount.
4. Click **Send**.

- The email is sent under your business's name, and customers' replies go to your business email from Settings.
- The page lists when the document was emailed before, to whom and by whom.
- On a busy system the email is sent in the background a moment later; the message then says "is being emailed".

> **Important:** If you see "was written to the mail log, not sent", email delivery has not been set up on the server yet. Ask your administrator.

15. Reports (owners and managers)

Insights → Reports turns your records into summaries. Choose a report, pick the period (or your own dates), and read it on screen, **Print** it, or download it with **Download CSV** (for Excel) or **Download PDF**.

Report	What it shows
Sales	Invoiced sales by month, customer and invoice.
Purchases & Bills	Spending with suppliers, from purchases and vendor bills.
Profit & Loss	Sales against product costs and supplier spending.
Payments	Money received and paid out, by method.
Receivables Aging	Who owes you, grouped by how long the invoices have been open.
Payables Aging	What you owe suppliers, grouped by age.
Stock Valuation	Current stock levels and their value at cost and selling price.
Customer Statement	Invoices, payments and running balance for one customer. Can be emailed to the customer.

> **Tip:** Profit & Loss and Stock Valuation are only as good as the **cost prices** on your products. Fill them in on each product (chapter 7).

16. Backups and the activity log (owners)

16.1 Backups

Administration → Backups lists copies of your business's whole database. A backup is made automatically every night, and the oldest are removed beyond the number set in Settings.

- Click **Back up now** to make one immediately, for example before a big change.
- Click **Download** to keep a copy on your computer. Keep a recent copy somewhere safe, away from the server.
- Backups are SQL files. Your administrator can restore one if ever needed.

16.2 Activity log

Administration → Activity Log records who did what and when: documents created, changed and deleted, payments, emails, stock adjustments, sign-ins (including support sign-ins by platform staff) and settings changes.

Use **Search** (for example an invoice number or a name), **Person**, **Action**, **Record** and the **From** / **To** dates, then click **Filter**.

17. Plan & billing (owners)

Administration → Plan & billing shows your business's plan and payments to Billora.

- **Plan**: its name and price, and whether you are on a **Free trial**, **Active** or **Payment overdue**.
- **What your plan allows**: bars showing, for example, active users and invoices this month against the plan's limits.
- **How to pay**: the payment instructions (such as bank details) from the Billora team.
- **Payments**: every payment received for your account, with what it covers.

17.1 Trials, due dates and pauses

Situation	What happens
Free trial	Everything works. A reminder shows how many days are left.
Trial or paid time ends without payment	The account becomes **Payment overdue**. Everything still works, and a warning shows the date the account will be paused.
Still unpaid after the grace period (normally 7 days)	The account is **paused**: nobody can sign in, and a notice is shown instead. **No data is deleted.**
Payment recorded by the Billora team	The account is active again straight away, and the paid time is extended.

> **Note:** Reaching a plan limit never removes anything. It only stops adding more (for example another user or invoice) until the plan is changed.

18. Platform administration (Billora staff)

This chapter is for the team that runs Billora for all businesses. The admin area is at its own address, for example **https://admin.billora.novixtech.lk**, with its own logins; business logins do not work there.

18.1 Signing in

Admin logins are created by your technical administrator with a command (see the appendix). Sign in with your **Email** and **Password**.

18.2 Businesses

Businesses lists every business with its status, plan, trial end or paid-until date and sign-up date. Search by name, address or owner email. Click a business to open its page.

On a business's page	What it does
Change plan	Puts the business on a plan (or no plan, meaning no limits).
Record a payment	Enter amount, months, method, date and reference. Extends the paid time from today or from the end of time already paid, ends a trial, and re-opens an account paused for not paying.
Pause / Resume	Pause stops all sign-ins (data is kept). A business paused by staff is only resumed by staff, not by a payment.
Sign in as owner	Opens the business as its owner for support, through a one-time link valid for one minute. Recorded in the business's activity log and the platform log.
Download backup	A fresh copy of the business's database, for example to give a leaving customer their data.
Close account / Re-open	Closing stops sign-ins and keeps the data for the retention period (normally 90 days); the notice page shows until when. Re-open reverses it.

18.3 Plans

Plans → Add plan: give it a **Name**, a **Code** (used to choose the plan for new sign-ups), **Currency**, **Price a month** and **Price a year**, and its limits: **Most active users** and **Most invoices a month** (leave empty for unlimited). Switch off **Can be chosen** to retire a plan without affecting businesses already on it.

18.4 Daily checks

- Every night the system makes each business's backup, and moves businesses whose trial or paid time has run out to **Payment overdue**, then pauses them after the grace period.
- If a nightly task or a background job fails, an alert email is sent to every platform admin.
- **Recent activity** on the Businesses page shows sign-ups, payments, pauses, plan changes and support sign-ins.

19. Troubleshooting and questions

Question or problem	Answer
I forgot my password.	Ask your business's owner to set a new one on the Users page. Owners who are locked out can contact Billora support.
I forgot my business's address.	Use **Find my business** on the Billora website.
The sign-in code doesn't arrive.	Check spam, wait a minute and use **Resend**. Check with the owner that your email is correct on the Users page.
I can't delete an invoice.	Only managers and owners can delete, and only invoices without payments. Delete its payments first.
The new invoice total is refused.	An invoice's total cannot go below what has already been paid on it.
"Your plan allows …"	You reached a plan limit. The owner can ask for a bigger plan.
A quotation can't be converted again.	It was already converted; click **Converted to Invoice #…** to open that invoice.
Stock looks wrong.	Open the product: its history shows every change and its source. Use **Adjust stock → Set count** after a physical count.
The logo doesn't show on documents.	Upload a PNG or JPG of up to 2 MB in Settings → Logo, then save.
Customer emails are not arriving.	Check the address and spam folder. If you see "written to the mail log", email delivery isn't set up on the server.
"This account is paused"	The business's plan is unpaid or the account was paused. The owner can check Plan & billing or contact support.

Appendix A. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Business (tenant)	One company using Billora, with its own address, users and data.
Address / subdomain	The web address of a business, for example acme.billora.novixtech.lk.
AR (accounts receivable)	Money customers owe you.
Aging	Grouping unpaid amounts by how long they have been outstanding.
Balance	What is still owed on a document: its total minus payments.
Plan	What a business pays for, with its limits (users, invoices a month).
Grace period	Days an overdue account keeps working before it is paused.
Platform admin	Billora staff who manage all businesses.

Appendix B. For the technical administrator

These commands are run on the server from the application's **laravel** folder, as the web server user (for example prefix them with `sudo -u www`).

Task	Command
Create or reset a platform admin	`php artisan platform:admin you@example.com --name="Your Name"`
Create a business by hand	`php artisan tenants:create acme --name="Acme Traders" --owner=admin`
Run new database changes	`php artisan migrate --database=landlord --path=database/migrations/landlord` `php artisan tenants:migrate`
Check a business	`php artisan tenants:verify acme`
Run a command for every business	`php artisan tenants:run "sjpos:backup"`
Billing check by hand	`php artisan tenants:check-billing`
See or retry failed background jobs	`php artisan queue:failed` `php artisan queue:retry all`

- A cron task must run `php artisan schedule:run` every minute. It runs the nightly backups, the billing check and the background email worker.
- After running commands as root, give the files back to the web server user: `chown -R www:www storage bootstrap/cache`.
- Point an uptime monitor at `/up`; it fails when a database cannot be reached.